

EXCEPT / NOT Question Pack

25 Negative-Format Questions — Full Answer Key

Print Edition

Week 9 · Inquiry Continued (Limbs–Children) & Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 · Lecture 9
(Final Lecture)

How to use this pack: Negative-format questions ("All of the following EXCEPT...") are where students lose points even when they know the material — one wrong-in-context option hides among three correct ones. For each question, mark every option T (true/belongs) or F (false/doesn't belong) before picking your final answer — don't just scan for "the weird one."

EXCEPT / NOT Questions

1. All of the following are correctly paired limb findings EXCEPT:

- A. Tingling sensation — Blood deficiency
- B. Numbness, often unilateral — Wind or Wind-Phlegm
- C. Feeling of heaviness/swelling — Dampness
- D. Pain — Liver-Yang rising

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

2. All of the following are true of Atrophy/Flaccidity & Tremor EXCEPT:

- A. Beginning stages are due to Stomach and Spleen-Qi deficiency
- B. Later stages are due to a deficiency of Yin of the Liver and Kidneys, or Yang of the Spleen and Kidneys
- C. Tremors always indicate Liver-Wind, which can be excess or deficiency type
- D. Tremors always indicate an excess-type Wind only

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

3. All of the following are true of Cold Hands/Feet & Weak Knees EXCEPT:

- A. Cold fingertips especially indicates Liver-Qi stagnation
- B. Cold feet in women specifically is attributed to Liver-Blood deficiency
- C. Weak knees is due to a deficiency of the Kidneys, especially Kidney-Yang
- D. Cold hands with palpitations and dizziness indicates Kidney-Yang deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

4. All of the following are true about Sleep EXCEPT:

- A. Sleep depends on the state of Blood and Yin, especially of the Heart and Liver
- B. Waking up many times during the night indicates Yin deficiency with Empty Heat
- C. Waking early and failing to fall back asleep indicates Gall Bladder deficiency
- D. Dream-symbolism material from the Nèijīng is confirmed as testable this week

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

5. All of the following Insomnia presentations are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Insomnia with anxiety, dream-disturbed sleep, other Qi/Blood-deficiency signs — Heart and Spleen Blood deficiency
- B. Insomnia with difficulty falling asleep, dizziness, blurred vision — Liver Blood deficiency
- C. Insomnia, waking frequently with excessive dreams, night sweating, palpitations — Heart and Kidney Yin deficiency with Empty-Heat
- D. Restless sleep with excessive dreams — Kidney-Yang deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

6. All of the following are true of Sweating EXCEPT:

- A. Daytime sweating indicates Yang deficiency
- B. Night sweating indicates Yin deficiency
- C. Sweating on the palms, soles, and chest is called "five-palm heat" and indicates Yin deficiency
- D. Oily, pearl-like sweat on the forehead that isn't flowing indicates Damp-Heat with a good prognosis

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

7. All of the following are true of Tinnitus and Deafness EXCEPT:

- A. Sudden onset indicates a Full condition — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, or Liver-Wind
- B. Gradual onset indicates an Empty condition — Kidney deficiency
- C. Noise aggravated by pressing on the ears indicates a Full condition
- D. A low-pitched noise like rushing water indicates Liver-Fire

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

8. All of the following are true of Feeling of Cold, Heat, and Fever EXCEPT:

- A. Fever intensity depends on the struggle between Zheng Qi and the pathogenic factor
- B. Fever intensity depends on whether the pathogen is Wind-Cold or Wind-Heat
- C. Simultaneous aversion to cold and fever is the key sign of an exterior pathogenic factor invasion
- D. Alternating feeling of cold and heat indicates the Shao Yang stage

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

9. All of the following Cold/Heat-by-location findings are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Cold limbs and abdomen — Spleen-Yang/Stomach-Yang deficiency
- B. Cold hands and feet, especially the fingers — Liver Qi stagnation
- C. Cold legs, knees, feet, and back — Kidney-Yang deficiency
- D. Heat in the afternoon or evening — Damp-Heat exclusively, never Yin deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

10. All of the following are true of Emotional Symptoms EXCEPT:

- A. The Heart alone "knows" what an emotion is, because it houses the Shen
- B. Depression with insomnia, palpitations, tiredness, weak limbs, and loose stools indicates Spleen and Heart-Blood deficiency
- C. Severe anxiety with stabbing chest pain radiating to the inner left arm and a purple tongue is the TCM description of a heart attack (Heart-Blood stasis)
- D. Every organ except the Heart is capable of consciously "knowing" an emotion

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

11. All of the following Anxiety (Full) presentations are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Hypochondrial distention — Liver-Qi stagnation
- B. Temple headache, tinnitus, deafness, dizziness — Liver-Yang rising
- C. Anger outbursts, red eyes, bitter taste, dark urine — Liver-Fire
- D. Manic behavior, mental confusion, swollen tongue — Heart-Blood deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

12. All of the following are true of Sexual Symptoms EXCEPT:

- A. Impotence with feeling of cold, backache, and abundant clear urination indicates Kidney-Yang deficiency
- B. Younger men with premature ejaculation are more often treated via the Heart
- C. Older men with premature ejaculation are more often treated via the Kidneys
- D. Excessive sexual desire is a pattern that can only occur in women

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

13. All of the following Menstruation findings are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Purple or blackish blood with clots — Stasis of Blood or Cold
- B. Pale blood — Blood deficiency
- C. Pain before the period — Blood deficiency
- D. Pain after the period — Blood deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

14. All of the following are true of Pregnancy & Childbirth EXCEPT:

- A. Miscarriage before 3 months is attributed to Blood or Essence deficiency
- B. Miscarriage after 3 months is attributed to Liver-Blood stasis or sinking of Spleen-Qi
- C. Vomiting during pregnancy is attributed to Stomach and Chong Vessel disharmony
- D. The 3-month cutoff has no bearing on which pattern is more likely

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

15. All of the following are true of Children's Health EXCEPT:

- A. Vomiting of milk and colic in babies indicates retention of food
- B. Chronic earache in children indicates Damp-Heat in the Gall Bladder channel
- C. Chronic cough/wheeze with sticky sputum indicates Damp-Phlegm in the Lungs
- D. Chronic earache in children indicates a simple Kidney deficiency, unrelated to channel pathways

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

16. All of the following are governed by the organs listed for the voice EXCEPT:

- A. Lung governs production of the voice
- B. Kidney governs volume of the voice
- C. Spleen & Stomach govern strength of the voice
- D. Liver governs the pitch of the voice

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

17. All of the following describe hoarseness patterns EXCEPT:

- A. Sudden onset, low pitch, raspy — Exterior syndrome
- B. Chronic, gradual intensity — Blood stagnation
- C. Plum-pit sensation with cough — Phlegm-Heat
- D. Chronic, worse in the morning — Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

18. All of the following are true of Respiration patterns EXCEPT:

- A. Excess/Heat = loud sound, rough/distressed breath, acute onset
- B. Empty/Cold = low sound, faint/slow breath, slow onset
- C. Excess/Heat is seen with phlegm-heat invading the Lung
- D. Empty/Cold is seen with a surplus of external contraction of evil qi

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

19. All of the following are Abnormal Respiration types with their correct mechanism EXCEPT:

- A. Asthma — Lung qi's failure to descend
- B. Wheezing — Lung qi fails to descend with phlegm obstruction
- C. Upper Stifling — Lung qi rises upward to throat, obstructs air tract
- D. Shortness of Breath — Excess Heart fire flooding the Lung

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

20. All of the following indicate a Full/Excess presentation EXCEPT:

- A. Loud, explosive cough
- B. Loud and long belching sound
- C. Sudden, forceful vomiting sound
- D. Quiet, low hiccup sound

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

21. All of the following are correctly paired Five Element Sounds EXCEPT:

- A. Wood — Shouting
- B. Fire — Laughing
- C. Earth — Groaning
- D. Metal — Weeping

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

22. All of the following are correctly paired Six Healing Sounds EXCEPT:

- A. Xū 嘘 — Liver
- B. Hē 呵 — Heart
- C. Chuī 吹 — Spleen
- D. Xī 嘻 — Triple Burner

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

23. All of the following are true about the general smell rule EXCEPT:

- A. Strong, foul, rotten, fetid, or stinking smell indicates Heat or Excess
- B. Absence of smell indicates Cold or Deficient
- C. A fishy smell generally leans Cold or Deficient
- D. A strong smell always indicates Cold or Deficient

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

24. All of the following are true of the Five (named) Odor slides EXCEPT:

- A. "Fragrant" is described as cloying and sickly sweet, not pleasant
- B. "Putrid" is compared to rotting meat or stagnant pond water
- C. "Rotten" is compared to a trash can/garbage truck
- D. Each odor slide explicitly states its paired Zang-Fu element

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

25. All of the following Odor-of-Secretion findings are correctly paired EXCEPT:

- A. Fishy breath odor — Phlegm-Heat in the Lung
- B. Heavy urea smell, scanty yellow urine — Heart fire pouring into the Bladder
- C. Odorless urinary incontinence — Exhaustion of Kidney fire
- D. Odorless urinary incontinence — Liver Qi stagnation

T/F each: A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___

ANSWER KEY

#	Ans	Why
1	D	Pain in the limbs indicates Qi or Blood Stagnation, not Liver-Yang rising.
2	D	Tremors can be EITHER excess or deficiency-type Wind, per the slides — not excess-type only.
3	D	Cold hands with palpitations and dizziness indicates Heart-Blood deficiency, not Kidney-Yang deficiency.
4	D	Prof. Schrier's own slide states dream-symbolism material "Will Not Be Tested On."
5	D	Restless sleep with excessive dreams indicates retention of food, not Kidney-Yang deficiency.
6	D	Oily, pearl-like sweat on the forehead indicates Collapse of Yang and signals imminent death — not a good prognosis, and not simply Damp-Heat.
7	D	A low-pitched noise like rushing water indicates Kidney deficiency, not Liver-Fire (which is a high-pitched presentation).
8	B	Fever intensity depends on the Zheng Qi vs. pathogen struggle, explicitly NOT on whether the pathogen is Wind-Cold or Wind-Heat.
9	D	Heat in the afternoon/evening indicates Empty-Heat/Yin deficiency, not exclusively Damp-Heat.
10	D	Every other organ is AFFECTED by emotion without being conscious of it — the statement inverts this relationship.
11	D	Manic behavior, mental confusion, and a swollen tongue indicates Phlegm-Fire harassing the Mind, not Heart-Blood deficiency (which is an Empty pattern, not a Full anxiety presentation).
12	D	Excessive sexual desire mechanisms (Liver/Heart-Fire, Empty-Heat from Kidney-Yin deficiency) apply to both sexes; Maciocia's text just happens to list it only under Women.
13	C	Pain BEFORE the period indicates stagnation of Qi or Blood, not Blood deficiency (which is the pattern for pain AFTER the period).
14	D	The 3-month cutoff is the key differentiator: before 3 months leans deficiency; after 3 months leans stasis/sinking.
15	D	Chronic earache in children is specifically Damp-Heat in the Gall Bladder channel — a channel-pathway-based answer, not a generic Kidney deficiency.
16	D	The slides assign only three organs to the voice — Lung (production), Kidney (volume), Spleen/Stomach (strength). Liver is not one of the three.
17	D	Lung/Kidney Yin deficiency hoarseness is described as worse in the EVENING, not the morning.
18	D	A surplus of external contraction of evil qi (or phlegm-heat) is the Excess/Heat mechanism, not Empty/Cold.
19	D	Shortness of Breath is attributed to Lung qi deficiency or Water Retention in the Chest, not excess Heart fire.
20	D	A quiet, low hiccup sound indicates an Empty pattern, not Full/Excess.
21	C	Earth pairs with Singing, not Groaning. Groaning pairs with Water.
22	C	Chuī 吹 targets the Kidney, not the Spleen. The Spleen Healing Sound is Hū 呼.
23	D	A strong smell indicates Heat or Excess, the opposite of what this option states.
24	D	Unlike the Five Element Sounds slides, the Five Odor slides do NOT explicitly pair each odor with an element.
25	D	Odorless urinary incontinence indicates exhaustion of Kidney fire, not Liver Qi stagnation.